

RoadMap

Each target will be different, study the before interacting. Don't be naive.

Recommended readings:

1. How to Win Friends & Influence People <https://www.amazon.com/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0671027034>
2. Social Engineering <https://www.amazon.com/Social-Engineering-Art-Human-Hacking/dp/0470639539>
3. Social Engineering: The Science of Human Hacking <https://www.amazon.com/Social-Engineering-Science-Human-Hacking/dp/111943338X>
4. It's Not All About Me <https://www.amazon.com/Its-Not-About-Revised-Updated-ebook/dp/B0FFBNCHP2>
5. The Like Switch: An Ex-FBI Agent's Guide to Influencing, Attracting, and Winning People Over https://www.amazon.com/The-Like-Switch-audiobook/dp/B00RKI81A6/ref=tmm_aud_swatch_0
6. Messing with the Enemy <https://www.amazon.com/Messing-Enemy-Surviving-Terrorists-Russians/dp/0062795988>

1.OSINT

Open source intelligence and gathering from public sources.

- Who someone is
- What role they have
- What systems/companies do they interact with
- Their habits, interest, relationships, routines
- Their language, tone, communication patterns
- Their possible stress points, motivations

Source Examples: LinkedIn, company websites, GitHub, social media, data breaches, public records, conference talks, old usernames, emails, emails formats, phone numbers, leaked metadata.

2.Communication modeling

Studying how a person/group communicates

- Formal/casual tone
- Common greetings and sign offs
- Response speed

- Preferred platforms
- Vocabulary and phrases
- Who usually do they talk to
- What requests are normal
- Urgency of the environment

Defensive Side:

Check for imitating behavior.

Separate: Authentic behavior, impersonation, sock puppets, staged conversations, copycat writing, detect scripted behavior.

3.Pretexting

The creation of a believable reason for an interaction.

Example pretext's:

- IT support
- HR, payroll
- Vendor follow up
- Law enforcement / authority figure
- Journalist / Researcher
- New employee
- Customer support
- Internal audit
- Emergency contact
- Community member

Structured as: Identity + reason + urgency/context + request to action

Example:

Someone claiming to be from IT mentioning an MFA issues, references a real internal tool and ask an employee to approve a logging

4.Rapport building

Mainly utilizing empathy, making the other person safe.

- Can be build from:

- Similar interest
- Shared frustration
- Mirroring
- Using someone's name
- Active listening
- Small agreements
- Humor
- Familiar references
- Giving small favors / useful information

Rapport lowers skepticism before requesting something.

Pattern: Friendly, shared topic / identity, small/harmless request, personal/sensitive request, action request.

Defense: Check out for quick built trust turning into compliance.

5. Influence

Making someone take a decision without forcing them

Some key elements:

- Authority **Example:** The manager approved this
- Urgency **Example:** This needs to be done in the next 10 minutes
- Scarcity **Example:** The link expires soon
- Social proof **Example:** Everyone else already completed it
- Reciprocity **Example:** I helped you earlier, can you do this for me?
- Commitment **Example:** You already confirmed this, need to finish the last thing
- Liking **Example:** We are both on the same side
- Fear / relief **Example:** Unless you do this your account will be locked

Stack multiple influence tactics, combine them and use them to exploit the target.

Example: The director asked us to fix this before the audit deadline, everyone else completed it but we can help you, can you approve this?

In example authority, urgency, social proof and pressure in compliance is applied.

Manipulation

Influence with unfair pressure and deception.

Manipulation tends to leave the target objective distressed, instead of being healthy as persuasion it looks for total control over the target.

Some key elements:

- Control
- Guilt
- Fear
- Confusion
- Flattery
- False intimacy
- Artificial urgency
- Isolation
- Overload
- Forced choice

Point is to remove the person's sense of normal options

Elicitation

The art of getting information without directly asking for it

Example:

Wrong: What security tool does your company use?

Good: **Person A:** I hate how CrowdStrike always slow downs everything, are you guys dealing with that too? **Person B:** No we use Sentinel One

Some key elements:

- False statements **Example:** Does your company uses Okta, right? - [Even when fake]
- Assumed knowledge **Example:** When your SOC gets the alert, what happens then?
- Flattery **Example:** You seem like a technical one, how does everyone else handles that?
- Mutual sharing **Example:** At my last job we used Duo, what about you?
- Naive questioning **Example:** I' new on this, why would anyone need admin access?
- Complaint baiting **Example:** Your helpdesk must be a nightmare

Defensive: Control your information flow, check out for when someone invites you to explain, correct or casually share something.

Nonverbals

All the cues outside the actual words

In person include:

- Eye contact
- Posture
- Facial expressions
- Nervous movements
- Distance
- Hand gestures
- Clothing and presentation
- Voice tone
- Pace
- Pauses

[Everyone has their own non verbal's]

- Online include:
- Response timing
- Message length
- Emoji use
- Punctuation style
- Typing rhythm
- Formality shift
- Platform choice
- Sudden urgency
- Avoiding calls or video
- Over explaining
- Inconsistent time zone behaviour

Note: nonverbals are not proof by themselves yet can reveal a lot from an objective, someone nervous doesn't mean they are lying, someone confident doesn't mean they are truthful

Look for clusters and inconsistencies.